

Zhuofei Lu

Assistant Professor of Sociology (Computational Social Science), University of Warwick

Associate Member, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford

Department of Sociology, 42–43 Park End Street, Oxford OX1 1JD, UK
zhuofei.lu@sociology.ox.ac.uk · [Google Scholar](#) · [Homepage](#) · [Oxford Sociology](#)

Academic Employment & Affiliation

- 09.2026 – Present** Assistant Professor of Sociology (Computational Social Science), University of Warwick
- 09.2026 – Present** Associate Member, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
- 03.2024 – 08.2026** Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
‘GenTime’ project
- 07.2024 – 08.2026** Course Convenor, School of Global and Area Studies / Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
- 01.2025 – 08.2026** College Advisor, St Antony’s College, University of Oxford

Education

- 09.2021 – 06.2024** Ph.D. in Social Statistics and Sociology (joint), University of Manchester
Supervisors: Prof. Wendy Olsen (socio-economics) & Prof. Yaojun Li (sociology)
- 09.2023 – 11.2023** Visiting Ph.D. Researcher, Sciences Po, Paris
Collaborator: Prof. Laurent Lesnard
- 09.2020 – 09.2021** M.Sc. in Social Statistics (Distinction), University of Manchester
Supervisor: Prof. Tarani Chandola
- 09.2019 – 09.2020** M.A. in Communication (Merit), Hong Kong Baptist University
- 09.2015 – 09.2019** B.A. in Marketing Management, Hong Kong Baptist University

Teaching

- 07.2024 – 08.2026** Course Convenor, School of Global and Area Studies / Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
– Quantitative Research Methods (MPhil level)
– Statistics Methods (MSc in Sociology)
- 07.2024 – 08.2026** Master’s Supervisor / Examiner, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford
- 01.2025 – 06.2025** College Tutor, Hertford College, University of Oxford
Demographic research (BA in Human Sciences)
- 07.2024 – 08.2026** Sequence Analysis in R (annual workshop), Centre for Time Use Research, UCL

01.2022 – 01.2024 Course Instructor, Department of Social Statistics, University of Manchester

- Introduction to Statistical Models
- The Survey Method in Social Research
- Statistical Models for Social Networks
- Structural Equations Modelling

Research Interests

Sociology of work · well-being · time use · social stratification · machine learning · GenAI literacy

Editorial & Academic Service

- Editorial Board Member, *Work, Employment & Society* (ABS4), 02.2026 – 02.2030
- Editorial Board Member, *Social Science Research* (ABS3), 01.2025 – 01.2027
- Associate Editor, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 04.2024 – 04.2027
- Researcher Representative, Department of Sociology Research Committee, University of Oxford, 10.2025 – 08.2026
- PhD Student Representative, University of Manchester, 12.2022 – 12.2023

Peer reviewer for: Social Forces; Social Science & Medicine; Work, Employment & Society; Journal of Marriage and Family; Nature Cities; Demographic Research; Social Science Research; Research in Social Stratification and Mobility; Social Problems; Journal of Social Computing; Journal of Happiness Studies; Sociological Quarterly; Socius; European Psychiatry; Scientific Reports; BMC Geriatrics; BMC Systematic Reviews; Journal of Time Use Research; Global Health Action; International Journal of Women's Health; Current Psychology.

Publications

Lu, Z. indicates the author; * indicates corresponding author.

- [1] Lyu, W. & **Lu, Z.*** (co-first authors), Wang, S. & Kan, M.-Y. (2026). Vertical Education-Occupation Mismatch and Gender Division of Labour: A Longitudinal Dyadic Analysis in the UK during 2002–2023. *Work, Employment & Society*.
- [2] Cui, S., **Lu, Z.*** & Wang, S. (2025). Gender and Parenthood Disparities in Work Time Fragmentation in the United States. *Social Indicators Research*.
- [3] Guo, Y., Cui, S., **Lu, Z.** & Wang, S. (2025). Dependence and Precarity in the Gig Economy: A Longitudinal Analysis of Platform Work and Mental Distress. *British Journal of Sociology*.
- [4] **Lu, Z.**, He, Y., Shi, X., Xiao, S., Wang, Z. & Wen, Y. (2025). The Gendered Inequalities in the Mental Consequences of Work Time Fragmentation: Latest Time Use Evidence in the UK. *Social Indicators Research*.
- [5] Lei, C. & **Lu, Z.*** (2025). The association between financial strain and mental health: The mediating and moderating roles of sleep problems in the UK household longitudinal study (UKHLS). *Journal of Affective Disorders*.
- [6] Lei, C., Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (2025). The role of loneliness in mediating the relationship between financial strain and mental health: Exploring gender differences in a UK longitudinal study. *Public Health*, 242, 299–303.
- [7] Lei, C. & **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Loneliness as a Mediator in the Association Between Food Insecurity and Multiple Sleep Problems: Evidence From the 2021/22 UK Household Longitudinal Study. *American Journal of Health Promotion*.
- [8] Ling, W., Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Working Time Mismatch and Employee Subjective Well-being Across Institutional Contexts: A Job Quality Perspective. *Work, Employment & Society*.

- [9] **Lu, Z.*** (2024). Can work time fragmentation influence workers' subjective time pressure? The roles of gender and parenthood. *Sociology* (BSA).
- [10] **Lu, Z.**, Wang, S.*, Ling, W. & Guo, Y. (2023). Gig Work and Mental Health during the Covid-19 Pandemic: A Gendered Examination of Comparisons with Regular Employment and Unemployment. *Social Science & Medicine*.
- [11] **Lu, Z.**, Wang, S.* & Olsen, W. (2023). Revisiting the 'flexibility paradox': degree of work schedule flexibility and time use patterns across gender and occupational groups. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.
- [12] **Lu, Z.** & Zhuang, W.* (2023). Can Teleworking Improve Workers' Job Satisfaction? Exploring the Roles of Gender and Emotional Well-Being. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [13] **Lu, Z.***, Wang, S., Li, Y., Liu, X. & Olsen, W. (2023). Who gains mental health benefits from work autonomy? The roles of gender and occupational class. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [14] Wang, S. & **Lu, Z.*** (equal authorship, 2022). Is Paid Inflexible Work Better than Unpaid Housework for Women's Mental Health? The Moderating Role of Parenthood. *Applied Research in Quality of Life*.
- [15] Wang, S., Li, L.Z., **Lu, Z.**, Li, S. & Rehkopf, D. (equal authorship, 2022). Work schedule control and allostatic load biomarkers: Disparities between and within gender. *Social Indicators Research*.

Under Review & Working Papers

All working papers target world-leading journals.

- The Social Stratification in Generative Artificial Intelligence Literacy, Use Frequency, and Workplace Acceptance in 11 European Countries. *SocArXiv preprint*.
- Who Works from Home, and Who Enjoys It? Gender, Parenthood, and Affective Well-Being in Britain Before, During, and After the Covid-19 Pandemic. *SocArXiv preprint*.
- Double Disadvantages? A Longitudinal Study Exploring Intersectional Disparities in Life Satisfaction Among Gig Workers by Gender and Ethnicity. *Major revision in an ABS4 journal*.

Conference Presentations

- International Conference on Social Computing 2026: *National Media and Scholarly Contexts of Social Stratification in AI Literacy and Acceptance Across Europe*.
- International Conference on Social Computing 2026: *The Gendered Linguistic Geometry of Everyday Spaces in American English Discourse, 1900–2009: Domain-Conditional Feminization and the Asymmetric Emergence of Private Vocabulary*.
- ASA 120th Annual Meeting — Demography and the Future of Work (paper session): *Gender and Parenthood Disparities in Work Time Fragmentation in the United States*.
- ASA 120th Annual Meeting — Gender and Work (round table): *Vertical Education-Occupation Mismatch and Gender Division of Labour: A Longitudinal Dyadic Analysis in the UK*.
- 46th International Association for Time Use Research Conference (session chair & oral): *Impact of Work-Family Role Switching on Daily and Instantaneous Enjoyment: A Gendered Time-Use Analysis in the UK*.
- BSA Annual Conference 2023 — Sociological Voices in Public Discourse (oral): *Work time fragmentation and subjective time pressure: evidence from the latest UK time use survey*.
- BSA Work, Employment & Society Conference 2023 (oral): *Can homeworkers have more stable work schedules? A time-use approach to measure work schedule instability*.
- 82nd Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management (paper session): *Work Time Control and Allostatic Load Biomarkers: Differences Between and Within Genders*.

Invited Lectures, Speeches & Interviews

- Expert interview, BBC News Brasil, 8 June 2026: on proposals to reduce Brazil’s standard working week and the implications of flexible working for workers’ well-being and gender inequality. “*Fim da escala 6x1: por que jornada flexível pode aumentar exploração do trabalhador, segundo pesquisador de Oxford.*”
- Seminar, Business School, University of East Anglia, 26 May 2026: “AI literacy and acceptance in 11 European countries.”
- Seminar, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford, 27 April 2026: “The National Context of Social Stratification of AI Literacy and Acceptance in Europe.”
- Government of Alberta’s Public Safety and Emergency Services Meeting, 2 September 2025: “How quantitative social research can support evidence-based practice and policy evaluation.”
- Roundtable presentation: *Women and health: building healthier working lives*. Understanding Society & King’s Global Institute for Women’s Leadership, 16 July 2024.

Grants & Awards

- John Fell Fund (OUP Research Fund), University of Oxford (2026), £10,000, PI: “The National-Level Media and Scholarly Contexts of Social Stratification in Artificial Intelligence Literacy and Acceptance in Europe” (07.2026 – 01.2027).
- Reward & Recognition Award, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford (2026), £400, for outstanding contributions across research, teaching, supervision, public engagement, and departmental service.
- ESRC Impact Acceleration Account (IAA) Award for Public Engagement (2025), £1,000.
- Chinese Government Award for Outstanding PhD Students Abroad (2024), \$6,000.

Technical Skills

Software: R, Python, Stata, High-Performance Computing, SQL, L^AT_EX, GitHub, SPSS, UCINET.

Statistical methods: NLP, machine learning, sequence analysis, survival analysis, causal inference, multilevel modelling, longitudinal SEM, social network analysis, complex survey design.

Datasets: Corpus data (e.g. Google Ngram), news outlets (e.g. GDELT), multinational household panels (e.g. UKHLS), time diaries (e.g. MTUS, UKTUS, ATUS), biomarker data (e.g. ELSA).

Professional Memberships

Sequence Analysis Association · British Sociological Association · British Population Association · Work and Family Researchers Network

Languages

English (fluent) · Mandarin (native) · Cantonese (fluent) · Hokkien (fluent)

Last updated: August 2026.